iii. Human Geography: It describes the human culture, population, dynamic socio economic and political aspects.

iv. Geographical methods and techniques: It is concerned with methods and techniques for field studies, qualitative, quantitative and cartographic analysis.

1.6.2 Regional Approach

It is otherwise called as ideographical approach. It was developed by Carl Ritter (1779 – 1859), a contemporary of Humbolt. The regions could be classified based on a single factor like relief, rainfall, vegetation, percapita income or there could also be multi-factor regions formed by the association of two or more factors. Administrative units like states, districts and taluks can also be treated as regions. The main sub branches of regional geography are : i) Regional studies ii) Regional analysis iii) Regional development and iv) Regional planning.



1.6.3 Geographical Data Matrix

The matrixis a simple method of arranging information in rows and columns for better understanding of complex spatial problems. **Brian J.L. Berry** adopted this method from anthropology for studying geography more effectively.Geographic data can be arranged in a rectangular array or matrix. Row-wise group of variables represent the systematic or topical branches of geography while, regions are represented by columns. Berry has explained that regional synthesis could be derived with the help of a series of geographic matrices in correct temporal sequence. Each time period has been taken to be equivalent to a 'slice' of the three-dimensional cake. The diagram of ***'Third Dimension'*** makes it possible to examine rows and columns, cutting across time.

1.7 Branches of Geography

Based on content and the available techniques, the discipline can be divided into three major domains. Each one has many sub divisions which deal with specific objectives (Figure 1.7).

a. Physical Geography b. Human Geography and c. Geographic Techniques.

1.7.1 Physical Geography

It is the study of natural features of the earth such as land, water, air and living organisms. The changes taking place within and among these natural features and their resultant features are studied under its various branches. The branches of physical geography are:

i. ***Geomorphology*** deals with the distribution of land forms, their origin and the forces causing changes over these landforms. Geology provides basic information to the study of geomorphology.

ii. ***Soil Geography*** is a study related to soil formation, soil profile, soil types, their fertility level and distribution. Soil erosion and conservation measures are also dealt in this branch.

iii. ***Climatology*** deals with the study of global and regional weather and climatic conditions by analysing relevant statistical data. Meteorology provides basic information on the composition, structure and the changes in the atmosphere.

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